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CAS Registered Is Not EIS Ready

The Second BIR Gate Most Finance Teams Miss

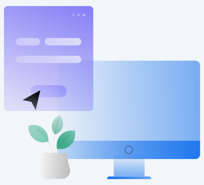
A field guide for Philippine finance leaders on the path from CAS registration to live e-invoicing under the BIR Electronic Invoicing System (EIS)

THE MYTH THAT COSTS THE MOST

"We already have a CAS" is the most expensive assumption in Philippine e-invoicing today. A Computerized Accounting System registration and its Acknowledgement Certificate (AC) do not make you EIS-compliant. CAS registration sits upstream of EIS onboarding. The two are sequential, not parallel, and you are not authorized to transmit a single live invoice to the BIR until the second track is complete."

The whole journey on one page

Getting to live e-invoicing means passing through two separate BIR gates in order. Gate 1 registers the system that creates your invoices. Gate 2 authorises that system to transmit sales data to the BIR. Finance teams get caught out because Gate 1 feels like the finish line. It is not. It is the entry ticket to Gate 2.



GATE 1: UPSTREAM

CAS / AC Registration

Registers your books of accounts and invoicing system with your RDO.

Output: the Acknowledgement Certificate (AC).

→ must complete first

GATE 2: DOWNSTREAM

EIS Certification + PTT

Technical validation of how you transmit.

Output: the EIS Certificate, then the Permit to Transmit (PTT), which unlocks production.

Who this guide is for

- **Finance leaders:** Controllers, tax managers, and finance directors who believe an existing CAS accreditation already covers e-invoicing.
- **Project owners:** Anyone scoping an EIS project who needs to size the runway, the gates, and the internal ownership before committing to a go-live date.

What you will walk away with

- A clear mental model of the two gates and why they are sequential.
- The ability to self-identify whether you are in scope, and whether one business unit pulls your whole entity in.
- A readiness checklist and a realistic timeline you can take to your steering committee.

Two Separate Tracks, One Hard Dependency

The confusion is understandable. Both tracks involve the BIR, both involve your invoicing system, and both produce an official document. But they answer different questions. CAS/AC asks "is your system a valid book-of-accounts and invoice generator?" EIS/PTT asks "can your system correctly transmit that data to the BIR?" You can pass the first and still fail the second.

Track 1: CAS registration and the Acknowledgement Certificate

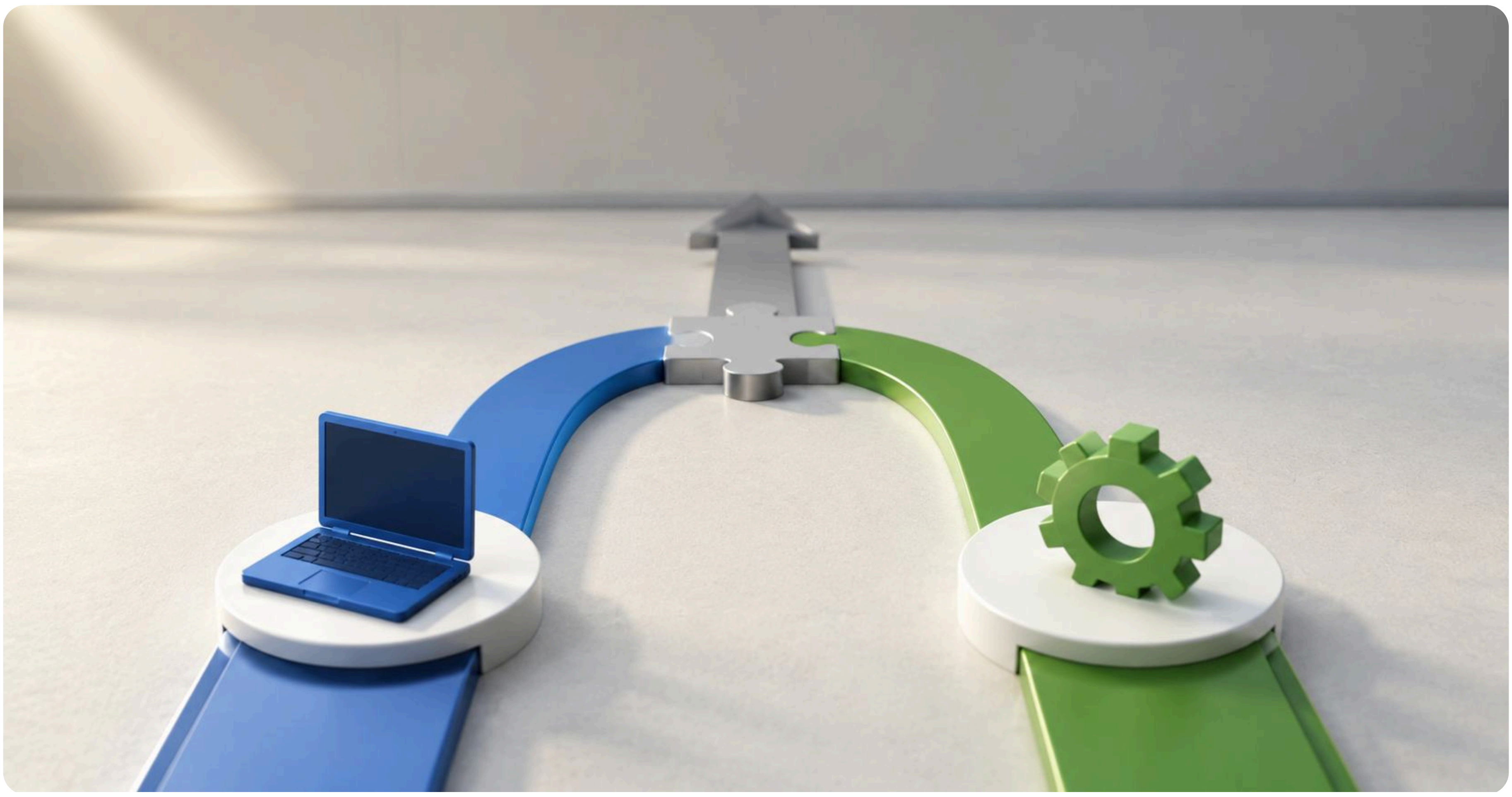
CAS/AC covers the registration of your books of accounts and your invoicing software. Since 2021, the process replaced the older Permit to Use (PTU) and system-demonstration model with a lighter approach built on a sworn statement plus sample system-generated print copies of receipts, invoices, and books. The substance is the same as the old PTU; the process is faster. The output is the Acknowledgement Certificate (AC), issued by your Revenue District Office (RDO), and its control number must appear on the footer of every invoice the system generates.

Track 2: EIS Certification and the Permit to Transmit

EIS Certification and the PTT are a separate, additional requirement specific to the e-invoicing transmission mandate under Sections 237 and 237-A of the Tax Code, as amended by the TRAIN Law and implemented through RR No. 11-2025. This track validates the technical pipe: structured JSON to the BIR schema, JWS digital signing, and stable API connectivity. Passing it produces the EIS Certificate, and only then the PTT, which is what actually unlocks the production endpoint.

WHY THE ORDER IS NON-NEGOTIABLE

Every e-invoice payload transmitted to the BIR must carry the taxpayer's AC / PTU number as a mandatory field. This is the dependency in black and white: no valid Acknowledgement Certificate means the transmission payload is incomplete, and the BIR rejects it. Gate 1 is not optional paperwork. It is a required field inside Gate 2.



The same system, two different BIR documents

	CAS / ACKNOWLEDGEMENT CERTIFICATE	EIS CERTIFICATE + PTT
What it certifies	That your system is a valid invoice and books-of-accounts generator	That your system can correctly transmit sales data to the BIR
Legal anchor	CAS registration rules (post-2021 AC model)	Sec. 237 NIRC (TRAIN); RR No. 11-2025 and RR No. 26-2025
Issued by	Your RDO or Large Taxpayer office	BIR EIS team via the EIS Certification portal
Output	Acknowledgement Certificate (AC) number	EIS Certificate, then Permit to Transmit (PTT)
Issued to	The taxpayer	The taxpayer (never the software vendor)
Without it	BIR rejects every e-invoice payload (missing AC field)	You cannot reach the production endpoint at all

WHY FINANCE TEAMS GET THIS WRONG

Accreditation is not the same as authorization to transmit. A registered CAS is an accredited generator of invoices. It is not, by that fact alone, an authorized transmitter of sales data. The transmission right is a second, technical approval that many teams do not budget time for.

Am I Even in Scope? Self-Identify First

Before you spend a peso on either gate, confirm you are actually mandated, and by when. The obligation sits on the seller. If you are a covered seller, every covered sale must be issued as an e-invoice regardless of who the buyer is. Use the categories below to tick your own box.

Covered taxpayer categories (RR No. 11-2025)

CATEGORY	IN SCOPE?
Large Taxpayers Service (LTS) registrants	Yes, in stage 1 (31 Dec 2026). Includes the legacy LTS list plus EOPT large classification.
E-commerce, online marketplaces, and digital sellers	Yes, in stage 1 (31 Dec 2026), regardless of size. Being small does not exempt you. Micro taxpayers are exempt.
Taxpayers using CAS, CBA, or accredited invoicing software	Yes, in stage 1 (31 Dec 2026). Using such a system is itself a trigger, whether or not it is already accredited.
Exporters of goods (Sec. 106) or services (Sec. 108)	Yes, in stage 2. Exports are zero-rated but still require an e-invoice.
Registered Business Enterprises with incentives (Sec. 304D)	Yes (PEZA, BOI and similar), subject to the phased rollout from stage 2.
Corporates with annual gross sales over PHP 1 billion	Treated as in scope under the working Stage 1 grouping.
Micro taxpayers	Exempt under EOPT. May opt in voluntarily.

THE BRANCH / HEAD-OFFICE RULE

Does adopting CAS for one entity or one business unit expand my compliance scope? Yes. If any branch or business activity of an entity is in scope, the Head Office and ALL its branches are mandated to issue electronic invoices for all covered transactions. There is no “comply at one branch only” option. A phased CAS rollout in a single unit can therefore pull the entire legal entity into e-invoicing scope, so plan the mandate at the entity level, not the pilot level.

Deadline and runway

RR No. 11-2025 took effect on 14 March 2025. The original compliance deadline of 14 March 2026 was extended to 31 December 2026 by RR No. 26-2025, in recognition of the system reconfiguration work required. The Commissioner may extend the period further if warranted.

Because both gates are sequential and each depends on BIR approvals, treat the calendar seriously. Allow 6 to 10 weeks end to end, and start roughly three months before your intended go-live so that a rejected filing or a failed sandbox test does not push you past the deadline.

Note: The 6-to-10-week runway is planning guidance drawn from the sequential approval steps, not a fixed BIR service level. Actual timing varies by RDO and by how quickly your system passes sandbox testing

Gate 1: CAS Registration to Acknowledgement Certificate

The Acknowledgement Certificate is the single most important piece of paper in the whole process. Without it, the BIR rejects your e-invoices on validation because the AC number is a required field in the payload. Yet the AC is a prerequisite, not the finish line. Here is what getting it actually involves.

The submission: a complete pack, or nothing

You submit a compliance pack to your RDO or Large Taxpayer office. The BIR issues the AC within three working days, but only if the submission is complete. If anything is missing, the receiving officer returns the pack and you re-file from scratch. There is no partial credit and the clock restarts.

THE 9-ITEM PACK	WHAT IT MEANS
Sworn statement (notarized)	Signed declaration that the system will be used and meets BIR standards; lists the modules and version going live.
System and company profile	One-pager on the architecture, cloud versus on-premises, and modules in scope.
Sample invoice printouts	Actual invoices the system will generate, showing all BIR-mandatory fields rendered correctly.
List of system-generated reports	Every report, its purpose, and a sample layout.
Books-of-accounts facsimile	How the system produces the general ledger, sales journal, and other books.
BIR Form 2303	The taxpayer's existing registration certificate.
Annex B compliance matrix	The most scrutinised item: a line-by-line mapping of each BIR rule to the matching system feature.
User / technical manual	Standard operating documentation, plus a vendor authorization letter if the system is third-party.
Audit-trail and 10-year retention plan	Evidence that records cannot be silently changed and can be produced on demand for ten years.

Note: The nine-item composition and the three-working-day issuance reflect current CAS registration practice. Confirm the exact document list and timing against your RDO and the governing RMC/RMO before filing.

Where teams lose weeks

- **Restart risk:** An incomplete pack does not get corrected in place. It is returned, and the three-day clock only starts again when you re-file everything.
- **Scope mismatch:** Registering the system for one unit while the entity operates other invoicing systems that are not covered. The AC covers only what you registered.
- **Re-registration:** A major change (new module affecting books or invoices, database engine change, on-premises to cloud migration) requires a fresh AC application before go-live. Every TIN or branch code files its own AC.

THE LIMIT OF THE AC

What the AC does NOT give you: the right to transmit. The Acknowledgement Certificate certifies that your system generates valid invoices and books. It says nothing about your ability to send that data to the BIR. That right lives entirely in Gate 2, and it is a separate technical validation.

Gate 2: EIS Certification to Permit to Transmit

This is the gate finance teams underestimate, because it is technical rather than clerical. The BIR is not reviewing paperwork here. It is testing whether your system can actually build, sign, and transmit a compliant payload, and it validates that in a joint sandbox exercise with the BIR before issuing anything.

What actually gets tested

- **Structured data:** Every covered sale becomes a structured JSON document matching the BIR schema (XML is also accepted). PDFs, scans, and emails do not count as electronic invoices.
- **Digital signing:** Each payload is wrapped in a JSON Web Signature (JWS) using RS256 (RSA with SHA-256), so the BIR can confirm the data was not tampered with after it left your system.
- **API stability:** A REST connection to the EIS that authenticates, issues, and confirms results reliably, tested against the BIR sandbox.

This is a distinct technical gate, separate from your CAS/AC paperwork. Your invoicing system may be perfectly registered and still fail here on a schema mismatch or a signing error.

The portal journey for you

1
1. Register on the portal
Sign up at eis-cert.bir.gov.ph with your company authorization documents, official IDs for authorized representatives, and confirmed BIR registration/TIN. During sign-up, you nominate your Software Provider.

2
2. Generate keys
Generate the application key and the digital signing key-pair (public and private keys). Verify by email, download the credential files, and store them safely. The private key is shown only once.

3
3. Test in the sandbox
Configure your transmission system and pass the BIR sandbox API tests (Authentication, Invoice Issuance, and Inquiry Result). This is a joint validation with the BIR.

4
4. Request the EIS Certificate
Once all tests pass, request the certificate. The BIR reviews your test transmissions and issues the EIS Certificate to the taxpayer, with a certification number.

5
5. Obtain the PTT
Submit the PTT document pack. On approval, the Permit to Transmit is issued and you whitelist your production IP addresses.

6
6. Go live
Switch from the sandbox endpoint to production and begin live transmission, generally from the day after PTT issuance.

TWO THINGS FINANCE LEADERS MUST OWN

Two facts your team must own. First, the EIS Certificate is issued to the taxpayer, not to your software vendor. No vendor is “EIS-accredited”; a provider can only be “EIS-ready” and support you through certification. Your team is directly involved regardless of the software you choose. Second, the Permit to Transmit allows only four IP addresses to reach the BIR production portal. That is a hard ceiling, so plan your transmission architecture and egress addresses around it early.

Your Readiness Checklist and Timeline

Everything in this guide reduces to one linear path. Work it top to bottom. You cannot skip a step, and each one gates the next.

The go-live path

1	Confirm your mandate group	Identify your covered category and remember the branch rule: one in-scope unit pulls the whole entity in.
2	Get CAS/AC in hand	Complete Gate 1. The AC number must render on every invoice the system issues.
3	Prove system JSON / JWS readiness	Your system must output schema-compliant JSON and sign it with JWS (RS256).
4	Register on the EIS portal	Sign up at eis-cert.bir.gov.ph, nominate your Software Provider, and generate and safeguard your keys.
5	Pass certification testing	Clear the BIR sandbox API tests and the joint UAT.
6	Obtain the PTT	Submit the PTT pack, receive the Permit to Transmit, and whitelist up to four production IPs.
7	Go live and stay compliant	Transmit within the required window, monitor acknowledgment status, and maintain your archives.

Timeline at a glance

WHEN	MILESTONE	WHY IT MATTERS
~3 months before go-live	Start Gate 1 (CAS/AC)	Leaves room for a re-file without missing the deadline.
Weeks 1 to 4	AC issued; begin Gate 2 build and sandbox testing	Technical validation is the least predictable stretch.
Weeks 4 to 8	EIS Certificate, then PTT	Both require BIR approval; certificate precedes PTT.
By 31 December 2026	Full compliance under RR No. 11-2025 (extended by RR No. 26-2025)	The current deadline for covered taxpayers.

Note: Allow 6 to 10 weeks total. This is planning guidance based on the sequential approval steps, not a guaranteed BIR turnaround.

After go-live: the obligations continue

- **Transmit and monitor:** Transmit each covered sale to the EIS within the required window and monitor validation and acknowledgment status.
- **Retain:** Keep digital archives (with printed backups in the early years) and ensure records are retrievable for ten years.
- **Correct properly:** Corrections happen through credit or debit notes that reference the original invoice, never by silent deletion.

Registered is step one. ClearTax gets you ready.

Purpose-built for tax compliance: 1B+ invoices a year, 50+ countries live, 5,000+ enterprise clients. Built for the scale and regulatory specificity of the Philippines mandate, not retrofitted onto a generic e-invoicing tool.

What ClearTax does is carry the technical weight of Gate 2. We integrate your CAS, CRM, or POS with the EIS, map your data to the BIR JSON schema, handle the JWS signing, and support you through sandbox testing and certification.

Regulatory Assurance

In-house PH tax team tracks every RR change; 4x faster go-live with the AI integration agent, and zero IT effort for mandate upgrades post go-live.

Performance at Scale

Auto-healing and deep validation to prevent failures, capacity for up to 10k invoices per second, and a 99.9% uptime SLA.

Delivery and Defence

Continuous books-to-EIS reconciliation, BIR acknowledgement token on every invoice, and 10-year retention contractually committed.

Ready to evaluate your Philippines readiness?

Get a personalised gap assessment, a BIR field-mapping walkthrough, and CAS registration and EIS onboarding guidance before your Wave 1 clock runs out on 31 December 2026.

Talk to our expert →